

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Survey

Survey scale

65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

Work module — employment, workplace, compensation, and purchasing influence

Global work participation is high (84%), but U.S. full-time employment fell to 64.8% in 2024.

Working now

84%

Respondents currently working

Full-time (global)

69%

Dominant work mode

Freelance/contract

16.4%

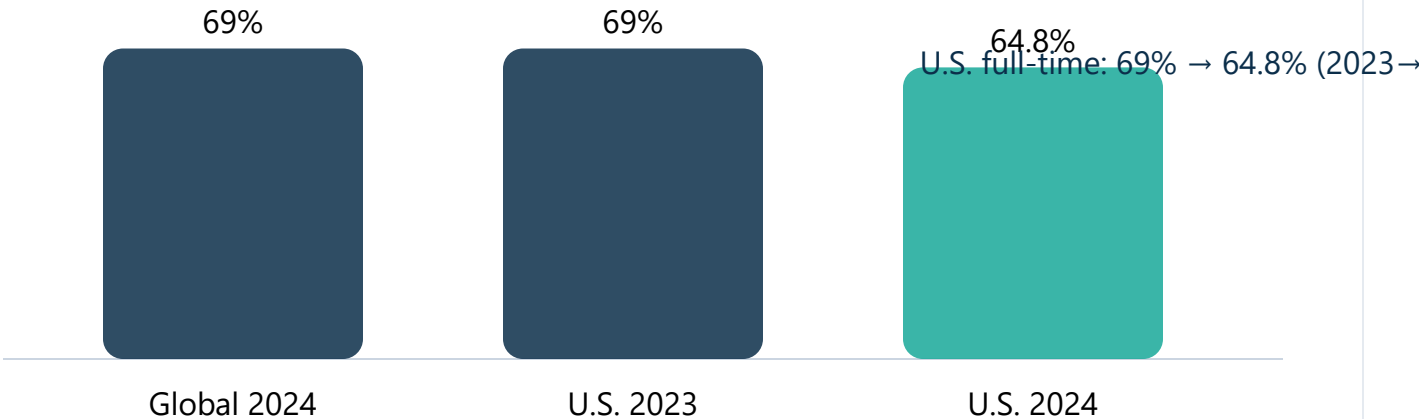
Independent contracting

Full-time students

13.2%

Still a sizeable segment

Full-time employment: Global vs U.S.

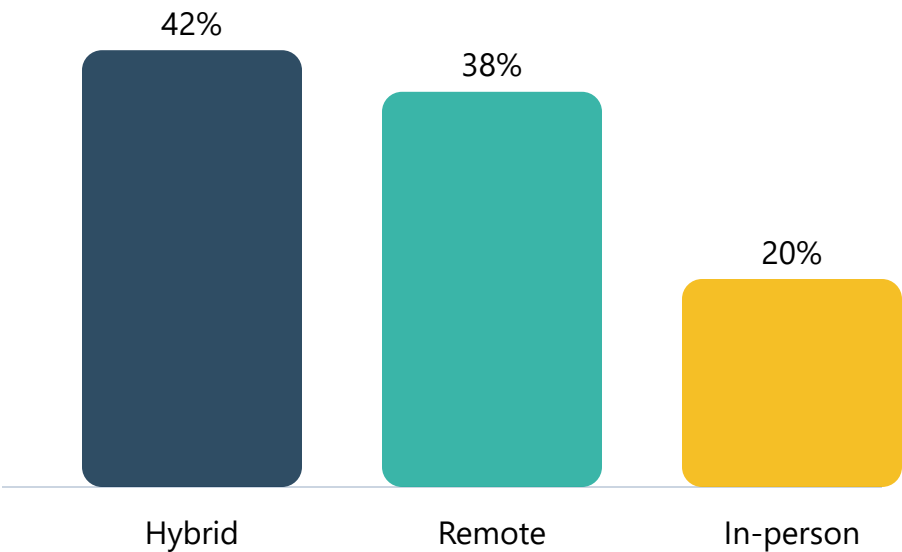


Implications

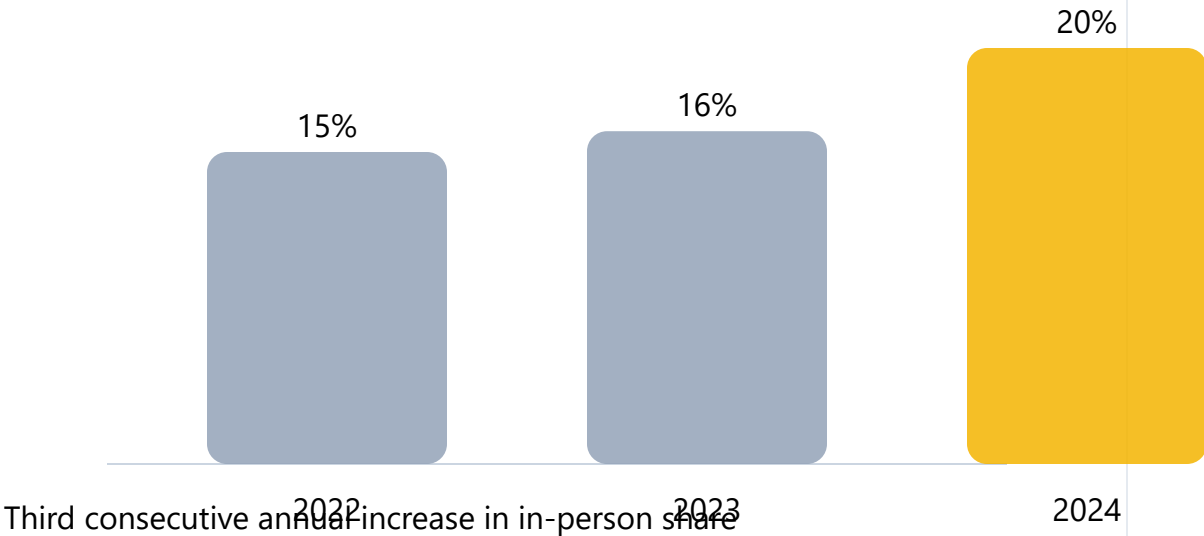
- More flexible workforce mix may persist.
- Benchmark offers across FT and contract bands.
- Monitor regional differences in non-full-time work.

Hybrid holds at 42% while in-person work rose to 20% in 2024 (up from 15% in 2022).

2024 work arrangement mix

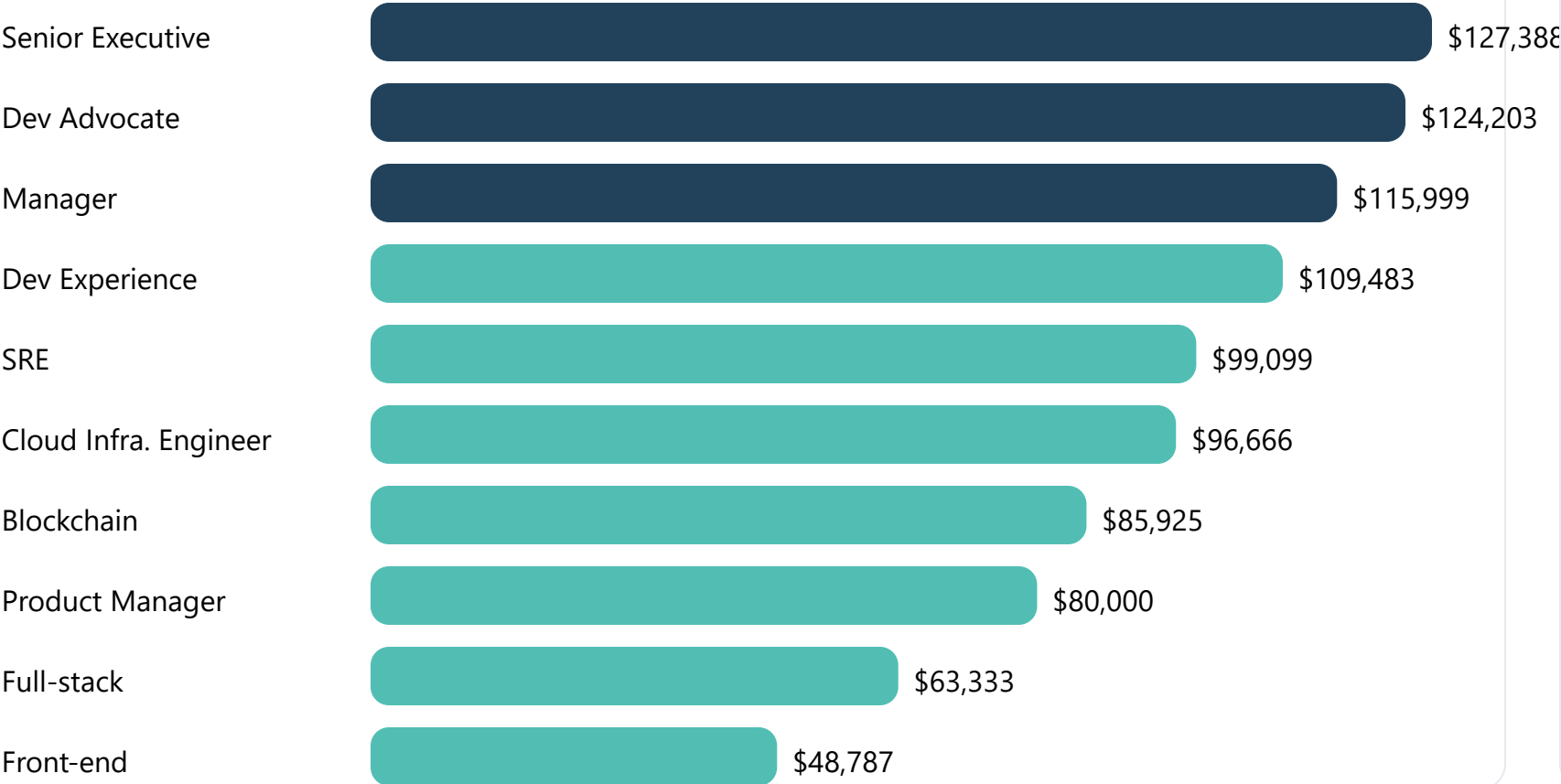


In-person trend (2022–2024)



Median compensation spans ~2.6x across the top 10 roles (from \$48,787 to \$127,388).

Median salary (USD) — Top 10 developer roles



Reference

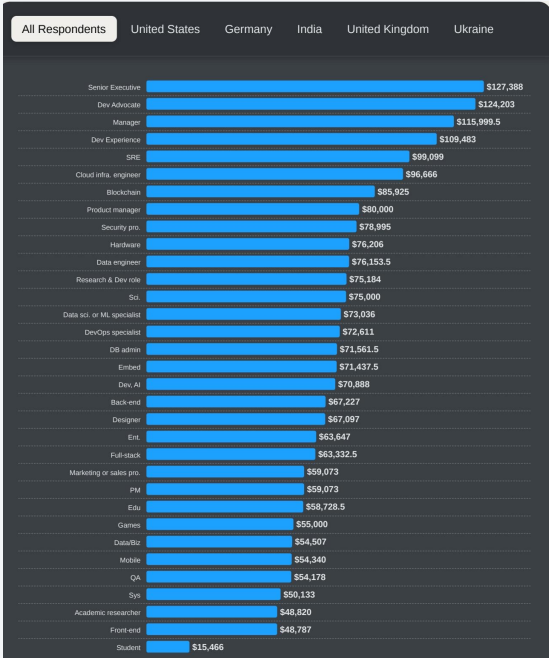
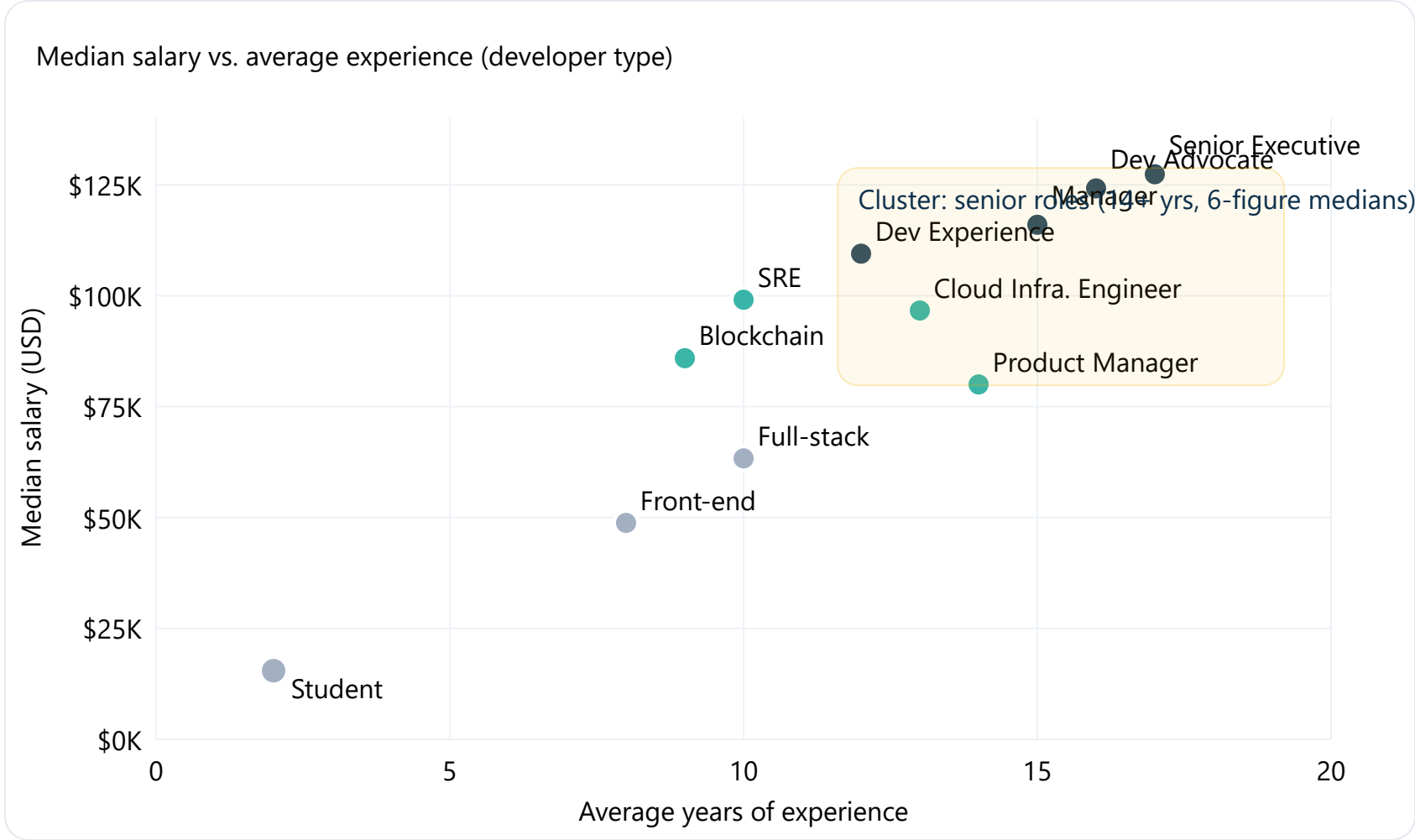


Figure 1: Salary by developer type

Leadership and DevRel roles combine ~15–17 years experience with \$116K–\$127K median salaries.



Reference

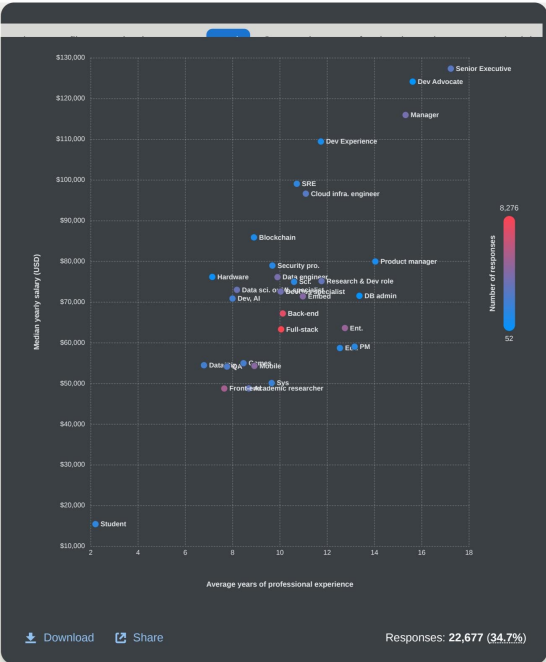
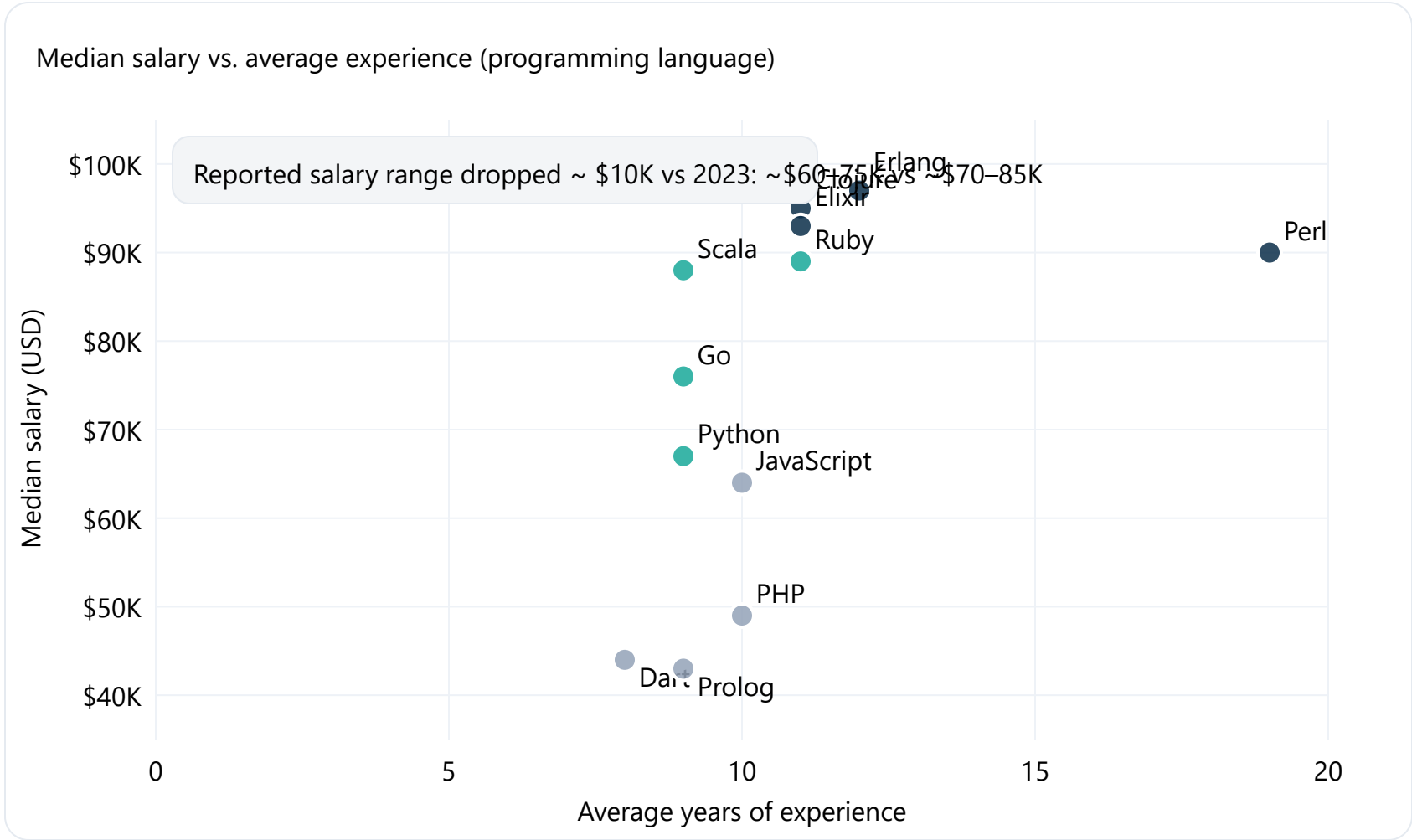
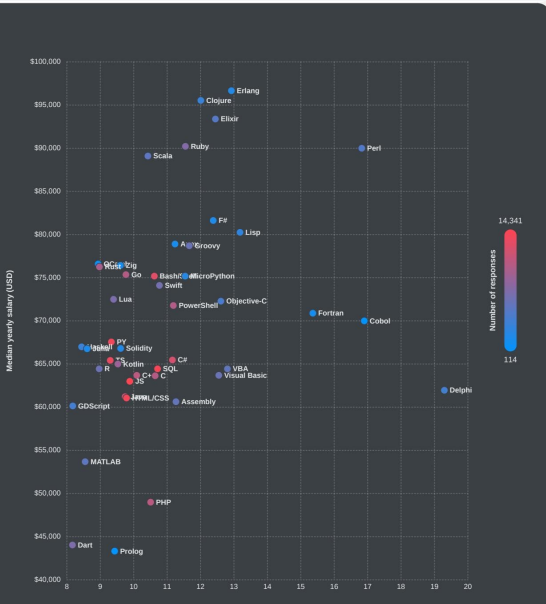


Figure 2: Salary vs. experience by role

Top earners: Erlang (~\$97K), Clojure (~\$95K), Elixir (~\$93K); lowest: Dart (~\$44K), Prolog (~\$43K).

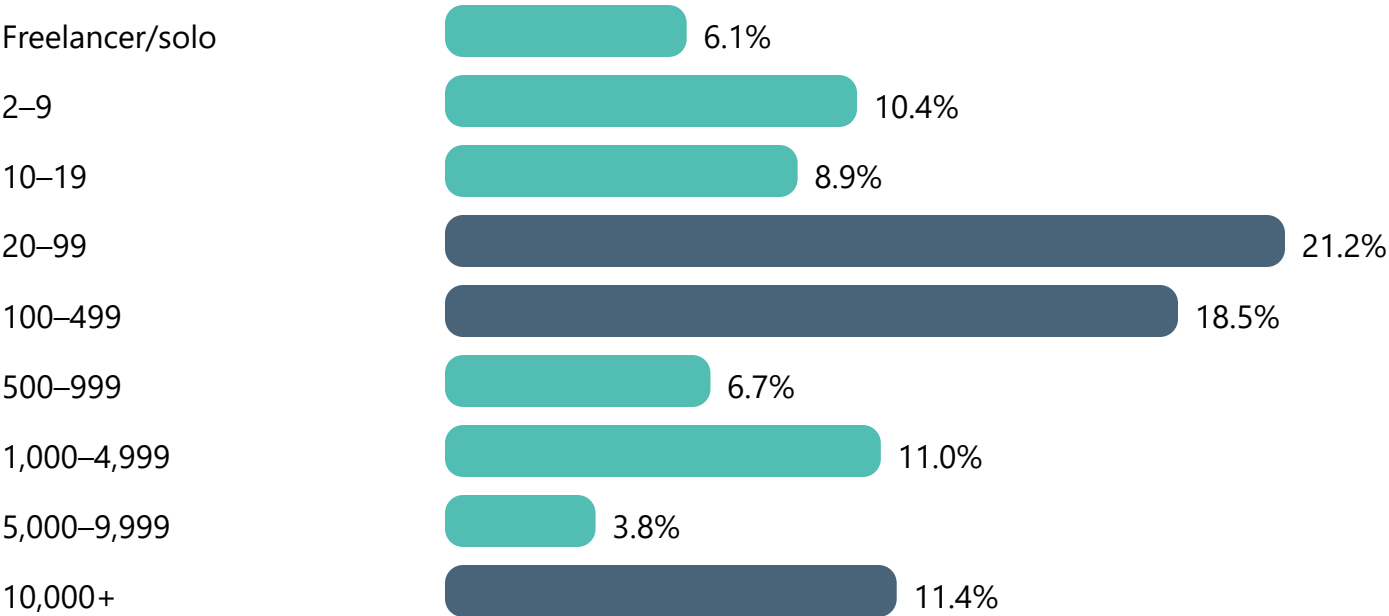


Reference



47% work at organizations with <100 employees; 62% influence technology purchases.

Company size distribution (n=42,827)



Purchasing influence

Influence tech purchases

62%

Prefer build-and-buy

60%

Start with free trial

75%

Ask other developers

73%

What to do with these signals

- Plan for flexibility: U.S. full-time fell to 64.8% (from 69% in 2023); freelancing remains 16.4% globally.
- Calibrate workplace policy: in-person rose to 20% (from 15% in 2022) while hybrid still leads at 42%.
- Budget for premium roles: Senior Exec (\$127K), Dev Advocate (\$124K), Manager (\$116K); top technical roles include SRE (\$99K) and Cloud Infra. (\$96.7K).
- Use language as a signal: Erlang/Clojure/Elixir earn >\$93K median; Dart/Prolog are below \$45K.
- Treat developers as economic buyers: 62% influence purchases; evaluation often starts with free trials (75%) and peer input (73%).

Use these benchmarks to calibrate offers, role leveling, and workforce mix across remote/hybrid/in-person expectations.